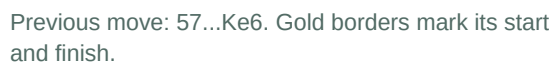


## Hook mating nets

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



The defending king is on e6. Geometrically undefended: rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.



**58. Re7#**

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.